

Words you'll hear: a family glossary

The people who support your child often speak in abbreviations. Here is what the most common ones mean, in plain language.

ABA

Applied Behavior Analysis

A therapy approach that teaches skills by breaking them into small steps and using positive reinforcement. It is one of the most widely used autism services.

BCBA

Board Certified Behavior Analyst

The clinician who assesses your child, writes the treatment plan and supervises the team.

RBT

Registered Behavior Technician

The person who usually works with your child session to session, following the plan the BCBA designs.

BHT

Behavioral Health Treatment

The term California health plans use for services such as ABA.

Regional center

A nonprofit agency that coordinates state-funded services for people with developmental disabilities in California.

Early Start

California's early intervention program for infants and toddlers under 3.

IFSP

Individualized Family Service Plan

The written plan for Early Start services, built around your child and family.

IPP

Individual Program Plan

The regional center's written plan for services from age 3.

IEP

Individualized Education Program

The written plan for your child's special education services at public school. You are a member of the team that writes it.

FBA

Functional Behavior Assessment

A process for understanding why a behavior happens, so the team can teach a better way to meet the same need.

BIP

Behavior Intervention Plan

The plan that comes from an FBA. It describes how the team will prevent a behavior and what to teach instead.

Reinforcement

Something that follows a behavior and makes it more likely to happen again, such as praise, a favorite toy or a break.

Prompting

Help given so your child can succeed, such as a gesture, a model or a hint, faded out over time.

Generalization

Using a skill in new places, with new people and with new materials, not just in therapy.

Parent training

also called caregiver training

Sessions where the BCBA teaches you the strategies used with your child, so progress continues at home.

AAC

Augmentative and Alternative Communication

Tools that support or replace speech, from picture cards to speech-generating apps.

SLP and OT

Speech-language pathologist and occupational therapist

Specialists who often work alongside your child's ABA team.

Hear a word that isn't here? Email info@autismkin.com and we'll add it.